A-A-51391A
16 June 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51391
13 May 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPONGE, SURGICAL, (Gauze, Radiopaque, Precounted, In Trays)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Type I (Size 4 by 8 inches) Radiopaque Gauze Surgical Sponge of MIL-S-37023 dated 18 January 1974.

This commercial item description covers a tamperproof sealed tray containing a Sterile X-Ray detectable Surgical Gauze Sponge, suitable for use in surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics.

The sponge shall be in a sealed, peel-open tray containing 10 sterile x-ray detectable surgical gauze sponges, suitable for use in surgical procedures. The sponge shall be USP, Type VII, absorbent gauze except the filling thread count may be 8 to 11. The sponges shall be sterile when tested in accordance with the USP. The sponges shall be folded to the dimension and number of plies shown below. The sponges shall be designed so they can be opened to the dimensions shown below without exposing raw edges, and shall not contain, nor be prone to develop in use, loose threads or filaments. The sponge shall not fray or shred when wet.

TYPE	NOMINAL FOLDED DIMENSIONS (INCHES)	NUMBER OF PLIES FOLDED	NOMINAL OPENED DIMENSIONS (INCHES)
I	4 by 8	12	4 by 23
II	4 by 4	16	4 by 16

AMSC/NA FSC 6510

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The x-ray detectable insert shall be fabricated of plastic material and shall be impregnated with an inert, nontoxic substance which is opaque to x-rays. The x-ray detectable insert may be monofilament not less than 0.381 mm in thickness and equal to the length of gauze in the warp direction, or tab measuring not less than 0.5 square inches, and the length shall be a minimum of four time the width. The x-ray detectable insert shall be anchored between the layers of gauze in such a manner that it will not fall out when the sponge is unfolded and vigorously shaken.

The tray shall be waterproof and of sufficient rigidity to serve as a vessel for fluids and as the immediate container for 10 sponges.

The tray shall be acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration for the product contained therein and shall be of such compatibility that neither the contents nor the container are altered in any way by each other.

There shall be no strike through or bleeding of the labeling and/or marking on the tray.

The sponges in the immediate container shall be precounted by the contractor. The sponges shall be banded or tied with a colorfast string into a precounted bundle.

The sponges shall be packed flat in the tray with each sponge and its x-ray detectable insert having the same orientation as the others in the tray.

The x-ray detectable insert shall not bleed nor show signs of deterioration, the precount band shall show no sign of decomposition or parting at the seal, and the precount string shall show no sign of decomposition, no appreciable change from its original color and no staining of the cloth; when they are subjeted to saturated steam at a temperature of 250°F for one hour.

Workmanship. The sponge shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

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Unit. Package (PG). Shall be supplied 10 sterile sponges in a commercially available, tamper-proof (not capable of being resealed after being opened or partially opened), sealed, peel-open tray which shall maintain sterility of contents unless tray is damaged or opened. The peelable cover of the tray shall have an easily accessible tab or edge for opening. The number of trays in one unit shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item. Testing and examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with all specification requirements. Test methods shall be suitable, accurate and reproducible.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for examination shall be one package. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level II, AQL 2.5 maximum percent defective except that the AQL shall be 4.0 for the following: x-ray element misplacement, poor sponge stacking, and bundle not banded.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION	TYPE
6510-00-116-1285	SPONGE, SURGICAL, Gauze, Radiopaque, 4 by 8 Inches, 800s	I
NOT ASSIGNED	SPONGE, SURGICAL, Gauze, Radiopaque, 4 by 8 Inches, 640s	I
6510-00-226-3649	SPONGE, SURGICAL, Gauze, Radiopaque, 4 by 4 Inches, 1280s	II

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking, and number of trays in one unit must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 05196

Project No. 6510-0768

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51391A	Sponge, Surgical (Gauze, Radiopaque, Precounted, In trays

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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